This is not unusual in societies that have a history of military dictatorships. But today, although no longer ruled by a military dictator and having reverted to a multi-party democracy, political literacy in Pakistan remains very low – even in urban centres and among the educated middle classes' (Lall 2014).

23 This focus group included participants from Lahore, Sheikhupura, Muridke, Dera Ghazi Khan and Sargodha.

24 Translation: '*Today political parties are not here for politics but for the "kursi" (seat) or to grab high influential posts.*'

25 Translation: '*The reason for chaos and social destruction.*'

26 Translation: '*Beautiful collection of words which are never followed.*'

27 Translation: *'Through political awareness we can run our country in a better way.*'

28 This focus group included participants from Hyderabad, Sukkur and Karachi.

29 Translation: *'Social destruction and chaos.*'

30 Translation: '*Consciousness or awareness of political thought.*'

31 This focus group included participants from Hyderabad, Sukkur and Karachi.

32 Translation: *'No, because there is no point to it. If I find a party or leader who is sincere with the country and nation, then I will definitely get involved.*'

33 Translation: '*Women's psyche.*'

34 This focus group included participants from Hyderabad, Sukkur and Karachi.

35 This focus group included participants from Hyderabad, Sukkur and Karachi.

36 Translation: '*Heart still belongs to Mutahida.*'

37 Translation: '*In my area, we've been voting for MQM since my childhood.*'

38 This focus group included participants from Hyderabad, Sukkur and Karachi.

39 Translation: '*Does not even belong to itself.*'

40 This focus group included participants from Hyderabad, Sukkur and Karachi.

41 This focus group included participants from Lahore.

42 This focus group included participants from Hyderabad, Sukkur and Karachi.

43 The case of Ammar Ali Jan, an academic fired from Punjab University for his political views, in particular his support of PTM (Warsi 2018); seminars linked to PTM have been forced to be cancelled at private and government universities after organizers and university management received warnings from individuals claiming to be part of the security state.

44 Political parties engaging students have completely misused them in the past, destroying academic culture by creating issues of discipline in colleges and universities.

45 There is a difference between rural and urban youth which the fieldwork revealed and is discussed later. It seems that the data Khan refers to is largely taken from urban areas as the youth in the rural areas are actively involved in politics, pursuing local MPs, getting involved in mobilization and demonstrations.